Growing

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/41912370.

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General Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Part 9 of We've Made It This Far

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by JazzKat1213

Summary

"Hey, we had something to ask you – a good thing, we hope," Bow throws out onto the table at the end of dinner.
Even with the reassurance there's still a small spike of anxiety. Catra clearly feels it too, so Adora puts an arm around her wife for both of them. Melog nuzzles at their legs beneath the table but it doesn't help much. Catra makes the go ahead motion and some sparkles flutter out from Glimmer's cheeks as she smiles. (It's been happening so much everyone's used to it.)
"We were hoping that you would like to be the support-parents for our baby."

Glimmer and Bow are having their first kid and they want their Horde-raised, severely lacking in parenting skills, best friends to be there for them in a much bigger way than either Catra and Adora were expecting.

Notes

About 6/7 years after the finale.
Sweetheart is a specifically married Catradora pet name and I wanted to write about it and ended up with this.

See the end of the work for more notes

It wasn’t until Glimmer told them she was pregnant, and then a few months later when she actually started showing, that Adora and Catra both realised they knew fuck-all about pregnancy. They weren't *there* for Scorpia's pregnancy like they're here for Glimmer's. Needless to say they're learning most of it as they go. *Now* Adora knows Glimmer’s still got around four-five months left, it seems far away still but there’s already so much preparation. And after that it seems everything will get simultaneously easier and harder. It terrifies her a little (*way* more than a little), honestly.

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“We were hoping that you would like to be the support-parents for our baby.”
A pause. It’s about the baby, they’d be supporting Bow and Glimmer, but the actual word, Adora has no idea what it means. It sounds important enough her heart rate picks up just that little bit. “What does that mean, for us?”
“If anything ever happens to us…you’ll take care of the baby.”

It’s silent for a second, Adora freezes, as does Catra, and she would bet Melog too as a result. Adora’s very glad she’s holding onto her wife for this now, she’s sure Catra’s tail is going to start lashing any second. Catra looks at her, pupils spindle thin, and Adora sees all the worries she feels reflected in her eyes.
Catra speaks for them and she says exactly what she’s thinking, “You’d trust *us* with that?”
“Of course we would!”
Magic sprinkles out from Glimmer’s fingertips in a small shower as she gestures. Catra flinches away from it so minutely Adora

wouldn’t have known if she weren’t holding onto her. That usually only happens around Scorpia’s magic, it tells her how much this has freaked her out, and fuck, she *gets it*.
“You’ve seen us with kids, right?”

People in villages give She-Ra babies to hold sometimes for whatever reason. She does as she’s doing now; completely freezes, at least until the parents take them back. She’s not exactly better with the bigger kids, but she’s fine to let them climb up She-Ra if they want and she’s not lifting anything else. That’s about as far as her interactions have ever gone. Bow and Glimmer know that. Catra isn't any better, just as uncomfortable and out of her element. Kids *like* Catra, they think she’s cool (they’re right), but they’re too loud, too rough with her tail and ears.

“We’re not asking you to make a decision now. Still have a few months before they’re even here. Just think about it. You’re our first choice.”
Adora has no idea why they would be aside from sentimentality. It’s a bad idea. But this is too big for her to shut it down immediately in a panic. She needs to *think* about this.

Catra’s tail is lashing every time Adora sees her the rest of the day. Melog isn’t red but that doesn’t reassure her that much. They decide to stay in Brightmoon tonight instead of going to their home on the edge of the woods. But even during the short walk from the dining hall to their bedroom, Adora knows as soon as a door closes behind them they’re going to be talking about it. They really do need to. Most of the things Catra’s clearly been bottling up all day do indeed flood out as soon as the door closes.

“We can’t look after a baby!” That comes first, and she’s very right, they have no clue what to do. Catra turns around to her, some of the tension gone, but how her face turns pleading concerns her. “We agreed children weren’t a thing we wanted.”
Right, that. That worry she can fix. Adora hugs her wife tightly and feels Melog winding around their legs. She tells her calmly

because Catra needs it right now, "I know. I haven't changed my mind, sweetheart."
Adora can feel the way that helps as Catra hugs her back. It makes her feel more stable that they're clearly on the same page still for that part.

"All I've ever wanted was you, I never even went near the thought of kids. Even now it's just…I don't want to. You're the only family I need."
That was what Catra said a few months into their engagement, and she'd agreed wholeheartedly. Their friends and each other are the only family they need, the only family they want. Maybe that'll change eventually, but that's years away if it happens.

Melog says something and Catra glances down at them, turning it over in her pretty head. Catra sighs, steps back but grabs hold of both her hands. Her face is scrunched up but it's a playful wince if anything. "I'm acting like they just asked us to adopt the kid we'll probably never have to actually parent, aren't I?"
"A little."
Catra looks up to the ceiling, gnawing on her lip as Adora waits for her to find the words. "I want to meet their kid. I want to help them with it." Catra says it - declares it - to herself more than to her, she thinks.
She squeezes Catra's hands, brings her back down. "You just don't want to be responsible for them, I know. I feel the same. Nothing is going to happen to our friends, *and* we have my healing if anything ever did. I asked Netossa, she said support-parents are more of a contingency plan, formality, 'in case' thing more than anything else. She might have just phrased it that way to help, but it did."

"Right… So you want to say yes?"
"Yeah. They're our friends, and this means they trust us."
"And you're doing it for them and the kid *and* yourself? Not just because they want you to?"
She didn't consider that part. She got to her resolve about it not being their kid and stopped. Trust Catra to know she didn't ask herself that. Does she *want* to be responsible for her best friend's

baby if they couldn’t look after them?
Catra clearly sees her brain stutter to a halt and strokes up her arm. “We have time to make the decision. Think we’re a little overwhelmed right now.”
She sighs and leans in to rest their foreheads together. “Let's come back to it tomorrow.”

Adora lets go and goes over the dresser to get changed for bed but the idea isn’t as appealing as it was a few minutes ago. She doesn’t really want to lie down and let herself think. “Don’t think I can sleep right now. Can we train or something?”
Melog wanders over to their pile of cushions in the corner, curling up immediately. Contrary to that, Catra says, “Of course, Princess.”

Being the support-parents at least means her and Adora get to be the first apart from immediate family to be able to see Glimmer once the baby’s born. Melog’s obnoxiously bright glow must be from their own excitement since Catra’s sure it’s not her sickening amount of nerves doing that. Adora’s holding her hand when they actually get through the doors.

It’s quiet. And the smell hits her sensitive nose before anything else. (It’s not as bad as the Horde locker rooms used to be, she’ll deal with it.) The nurses move out the way: Glimmer’s drenched in drying sweat, bags deep under her eyes and skin blotchy. But fuck if she doesn’t look the happiest Catra’s ever seen her aside from her wedding day. Her, Micah and Bow are all grinning down at the baby, completely besotted.

Her, Adora and Melog barely get spared a welcoming glance. She doesn’t mind it. Melog’s first to the bedside, shrinking to fit better and immediately going to nose at the bundle on Glimmer’s chest. Micah picks them up so they can see the baby easier while letting Glimmer have her probably very-needed space. Catra kind of feels like an awkward looming shadow just standing at the bedside, but that feeling disappears when Glimmer turns the kid in her arms so her and Adora can actually see his face. He doesn’t have very

many features, really. A tiny person with a tiny face. Bow's eyes shine through when he blinks.

"Decided on a name yet?"
"Angel, after my mum."
She's not going to let any of the sour thoughts that are sitting ready take proper form. This is a good day, and Glimmer's clearly not thinking about how Angella's not here. Adora still hasn't said anything, but Catra gets a matching squeeze of her hand when she tries.
Bow cuddles closer to his wife and kid, murmuring as if Angel is asleep, "Think he'll get your hair, Glim?"
"Definitely."
It's not as if Catra hasn't seen Glimmer's hair a million times, but it feels like it, something just *off* until it clicks. "You've lost some of your sparkles, Sparkles."
It's clear Bow's just realised that too and Glimmer turns her head as if she'll be able to see it. Micah strokes his daughter's once-shimmering hair, saying, "Happened to Angie when we had you."

There's a pause where Catra waits for *something* to happen (her roiling stomach says something *bad*) but Bow just asks, "Adora, you okay?"
Adora snaps out of her stupor (it's cute) and gestures at the baby, "He's so tiny! Are they meant to be that small?"
Glimmer nuzzles down into her baby as he grabs at the air, "Yes. Perfectly healthy." Adora lets go of her hand, kneeling on the floor and warily reaching for the tiny hand in the air that latches onto her. "You wanna hold him?"
Adora's hand immediately retreats. "Uh, no, not yet. I'm terrified."
Bow looks up at her, "Catra?"
"No, same."

She promises herself later, hopefully when Angel doesn't look as fragile as glass, ready to blow away on the wind. She's good just looking for now, able to reach down and hold onto her wife if she needs her.

It takes them both a few days to feel like they won't immediately hurt the kid if they pick him up. Adora still freezes up completely. And Catra needs several minutes to be able to put her claws away through the nerves. But she's done it, held him and rocked him for just a few minutes at a time. Sitting down with the baby feels a lot safer, and it gives Bow and Glimmer a small slice of rest from the constant vigilance the baby seems to need. Catra's exhausted just watching.

Right now is one of those moments, a few weeks in. They're in the library late at night, Bow and Glimmer are curled up in front of the fireplace dozing, Catra's got the kid in her lap. Adora's gone off to find her another book. She's actually alone with Angel and there's a good helping of fear but she figures she needs to get used to this. He stares up at her, swaddled in fabric, occasionally gurgling. She stares down at him and whispers, "Can't believe I'm your aunt. Can't believe you don't understand what I'm saying, or that you can't walk or talk. But I'm going to try so hard to be an alright adult in your life, because it will really suck if I'm not. For both of us."
She knows Adora heard the last part of it, she doesn't care. Her wife puts the book beside her and squishes in next to her on the loveseat. It feels safe enough with her also here to purr, and Angel laughs with the vibration, not so loudly as to rouse his parents.
"You're already doing better than me."
"Not a hard bar to pass, I can actually move when I hold him."
Adora pouts, "I'm getting better."
"You are."
She kisses Adora's cheek and she motions for the baby so she can get back to reading (and probably to prove that she *is* getting better).

"We're going to be okay at this," Adora says when they're under their covers in their Brightmoon room, too late for them to want the walk to the woods. She purrs into her wife's chest, wrapped around her as tightly as possible. Maybe that's why Adora's talking

like she’s reassuring her. “We love Glimmer and Bow, and we love their kid.”
She rubs a scent mark into her neck, definitely not half-asleep as she mumbles, “You were really good with him today.”
“So were you.”
“Love you.”
“Love you too.” Adora kisses her ear. “You know I’m wondering how soon it’s going to be until he’s teleporting.”

End Notes

I personally don’t believe canon Catradora have kids of their own. But they’re gonna try so hard to be amazing aunts to everyone else’s. Catradora and Spinetossa are the Cool Aunts of the Rebellion.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!